



CI Institute of
Nursing

Draft / Pending Approval

Moodle Self-Host Implementation Requirements Only

Requirements-only handoff for planning, SME review, and post-approval configuration

Document	Operating context
Packet status	Draft / Pending Approval
Use	Execution copy for signatures, submissions, Moodle handoff planning, catalog safe-language updates, and survey readiness
Boundary	Official forms remain standalone and unbranded; CI-created PDFs are wrapper, index, course, and handoff documents
Moodle build hold	Planning only until Vanessa/SME approval; production learner access remains blocked until agency approval metadata where required

Approval boundary: This packet uses Draft / Pending Approval language only. It does not claim CDPH, CDSS/ACS, BRN, or other government approval. Certificates remain disabled until agency approval metadata and completion evidence gates are satisfied.

Purpose and Scope

This requirements-only PDF supports Moodle self-host readiness planning. It does not rebuild the full Moodle binder and does not claim agency approval.

Certificate gate: Certificate generation must remain disabled until applicable approval metadata is issued and configured.

Requirement Summary

Requirement area	Implementation requirement	Verification hold
Moodle version recommendation	Default recommendation: Moodle 4.5 LTS for survey-stable self-hosting and plugin compatibility (long-term support release lifecycle reduces forced upgrades during a survey window). Moodle 5.2 may be considered only if all required plugins, import tools (GIFT/CSV question import), themes, and the certificate plugin are verified compatible.	Version recommendation requires final technical verification before production install. Do not make unsupported version/security-support claims unless verified from current Moodle documentation.
Web server requirement	A supported web server (e.g., Apache or Nginx) configured for the chosen Moodle version. HTTPS enforced (see below).	Technical admin final verification required - confirm exact web server version against the Moodle release's requirements.
PHP / database requirement	PHP version and required PHP extensions as specified for the chosen Moodle release. A supported database engine (e.g., MariaDB/MySQL or PostgreSQL) at a version supported by the chosen Moodle release.	Do not hard-code specific version numbers here that are not verified. Technical admin final verification required - confirm PHP version, extensions, and database engine/version from the chosen release's official requirements page.
HTTPS / domain requirement	A dedicated domain or subdomain for the LMS. Valid TLS certificate; force HTTPS site-wide; set 'wwwroot' to the https URL.	Technical admin final verification required - domain ownership and certificate issuance.
SMTP / email requirement	Working outbound email (SMTP) for account creation, password reset, and notifications. A monitored no-reply/support mailbox.	Technical admin final verification required - SMTP host/credentials.
Cron requirement	Moodle cron must run on a reliable schedule (e.g., every 1 minute) for completion processing, notifications, scheduled tasks, and backups. Technical admin final verification required - cron configured and monitored.	Technical admin final verification required - cron configured and monitored.
Backups	Automated scheduled backups of the database and 'moodledata', plus Moodle automated course backups (.mbz). Offsite/secondary copy. See '14_DATA_RETENTION_BACKUP_AND_SECURITY_SPEC.md'.	Technical admin final verification required before production install.
Logging	Standard Moodle logging enabled; logs retained per retention policy; log export available for survey/audit (see '13_REPORTING_AND_AUDIT_EXPORT_SPEC.md').	Technical admin final verification required before production install.
Storage	Adequate disk for 'moodledata', database, and backups, with growth headroom. Technical admin final verification required - sizing based on expected enrollment and media.	Technical admin final verification required - sizing based on expected enrollment and media.
Authentication	Manual accounts and/or email-based self-registration controlled by admin policy. Strong password policy; reviewer accounts use temporary credentials with forced reset (see '04_ROLE_ACCESS_AND_WORKFLOW_MATRIX.md' and '15_REVIEWER_ACCESS_AND_SURVEY_WORKFLOW.md').	Multi-factor authentication for privileged accounts where supported. Technical admin final verification required.
Roles	Use the role set defined in '04_ROLE_ACCESS_AND_WORKFLOW_MATRIX.md' and 'import_assets/ROLE_MATRIX_IMPORT_REFERENCE.csv', including a custom read-only External Survey Reviewer role.	Technical admin final verification required before production install.
Permissions	Least-privilege configuration. Only Site Administrator / Manager may change site configuration, enable certificates, or perform documented grade overrides.	Technical admin final verification required before production install.

Requirement area	Implementation requirement	Verification hold
Plugin policy	Minimize plugins. Permitted/expected: a certificate plugin (e.g., a maintained Custom Certificate plugin) kept DISABLED until approval; optionally a configurable reports plugin. Only install plugins verified compatible with the chosen Moodle version and from trusted sources. Technical admin final verification required for each plugin.	Minimize plugins. Permitted/expected: a certificate plugin (e.g., a maintained Custom Certificate plugin) kept DISABLED until approval; optionally a configurable reports plugin.
Theme / branding	A maintained, accessible theme; CI Institute of Nursing branding applied conservatively. No approval-claim language in branding before approval. See `17_ACCESSIBILITY_AND_MOBILE_REQUIREMENTS.md`.	No approval-claim language in branding before approval. See `17_ACCESSIBILITY_AND_MOBILE_REQUIREMENTS.md`.
Accessibility	WCAG-oriented configuration (headings, alt text, contrast, captions/transcripts). See `17_ACCESSIBILITY_AND_MOBILE_REQUIREMENTS.md`.	Technical admin final verification required before production install.
No-PHI controls	Learner warnings, activity prompt rules, and a quarantine/deletion process for any PHI accidentally entered. Fictional, de-identified scenarios only. See `16_NO_PHI_AND_PRIVACY_CONTROLS.md`.	Technical admin final verification required before production install.
Privacy / security hardening	Force HTTPS; secure cookies; disable unused features; restrict admin to dedicated accounts; keep Moodle and server patched. Configure Moodle privacy/GDPR-style tools and a privacy policy page. Technical admin final verification required - jurisdiction-specific privacy requirements.	Configure Moodle privacy/GDPR-style tools and a privacy policy page. Technical admin final verification required - jurisdiction-specific privacy requirements.
Retention / export	Define retention for completion evidence and learner records aligned with each lane's recordkeeping requirements (see `14_DATA_RETENTION_BACKUP_AND_SECURITY_SPEC.md`). Exact retention periods: SME/legal verification required.	Define retention for completion evidence and learner records aligned with each lane's recordkeeping requirements (see `14_DATA_RETENTION_BACKUP_AND_SECURITY_SPEC.md`). Exact retention periods: SME/legal verification required.

Yadvir Operating Order Summary

- Tracker is the source of truth
- Aldrin and Dagny may review requirements for planning before SME approval
- Moodle development may not start until Vanessa Valerio, RN or another approved SME reviews and approves course materials
- Public approval language and certificates remain blocked until agency metadata is issued